# Empathy & user-centred design

CREATIVE THINKING WITH MR KELLY

Level 5 · Thinking tools · Worksheet

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

**By the end of this worksheet I can…**

- ☐ create a persona and an empathy map from research
- ☐ write a "How might we…?" question
- ☐ consider inclusive design

## I DO — Worked example

Read how a full-mark answer is built

*Brief: a product or service that helps older people in your town stay connected.*

**1 Create a persona for a typical user.** (4 marks)

**Full-mark answer** each ✓ is one mark

Margaret, 78, retired, lives alone in a flat on the edge of town ✓. She wants to see her grandchildren more and get to the community centre ✓. She has no car, the bus is infrequent, and she isn't confident using video calls ✓. Based on interviews with three residents at the lunch club ✓.

**Why answers lose marks**

*"An old lady who is lonely."*

1 point: very little detail and not based on research.

## WE DO — Guided practice

Use the starters and word bank to help you

*You interviewed a first-year pupil who said: "I got lost every day in the first week and was too embarrassed to ask."*

**2 Write a "How might we…?" question based on this.** (2 marks)

**Sentence starters**

One … is …, which means …

Another … is …, so …

**Word bank**

states · starts · first-years · first-year · challenge · pupils · around · clearly

Tip: 2 marks = 2 separate, developed points.

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**YOU DO** **On your own** No notes. Check your answers afterwards.

## 3 Quick check: tick one box for each.

**a)** What are the four parts of an empathy map?
☐ Who, what, where, when ☐ Says, thinks, does, feels ☐ Cost, size, colour, shape ☐ Research, concept, test, evaluate

**b)** Why design inclusively?
☐ It is always cheaper ☐ It often makes things better for everyone ☐ It uses fewer colours ☐ It isn't useful

**c)** A persona should be based on...
☐ Your imagination only ☐ Your research about real users ☐ A celebrity ☐ Your best friend

**d)** Which is a good "How might we" question?
☐ Make a poster. ☐ How might we help new pupils find their way round school on day one? ☐ Is the school big? ☐ Design a logo.

## 4 Key terms: write the letter of the matching description next to each term.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1. **Persona** | ____ | **A** A realistic profile of a typical user based on research |
| 2. **Empathy map** | ____ | **B** A question that turns a problem into a design challenge |
| 3. **User journey** | ____ | **C** What the user says, thinks, does and feels |
| 4. **"How might we…?"** | ____ | **D** Each step the user takes, with highs and lows |

*You are designing a new playpark.*

## 5 Describe what goes in each section of an empathy map for a parent with a pram. (4 marks)

**6 Explain what is meant by ‘Inclusive design’.** (2 marks)

**7 Explain what is meant by ‘Empathy’.** (2 marks)

**Check and reflect**
Mark your answers with the answer sheet. Go back to the checklist on the site and re-rate each “I can” statement above. Which one still needs work?